

Quick Guide: Primary RN vs. Vascular Access Team (VAN)

Primary Floor RN Duties (Does not include ICU, ED, Procedural areas)

ASSESSMENT & DOCUMENTATION

- Monitors all sites throughout the shift.
- Completing routine & PRN policy-driven documentation of lines & sites.
- Flushes lines AND must check for blood return.
- Manages complications & post-infiltration/extravasation care per policy.

LABS & INFUSIONS

- Draws labs from Central Lines as ordered.
- Note: VAN only draws labs if Lab Team fails.

DRESSINGS AND MANDATORY DEVICE LOCKING

- Perform 7-day dressing changes for PIVs per policy.
- Removal of EMS sites within 48 hours.
- Must lock lines per provider orders.
(i.e., Saline lock post-labs, Heparin locks, or antibiotic locks)

 Immediate Consult: If a PICC, CVC, IVAD, or Midline dressing is soiled/lifting and RN lacks competency.

DEVICE REMOVALS

- Removes all standard PIVs, idle PIVs, and immediately for PIVs with complications.
- Removes Non-trimmable (PowerGlide) Midlines (No specialized competency required, RN only). LDA will tell RN if non-trimmable.
- If RN has validated competency in file may perform CVC, trimmable PICC & midline per policy specifications and competency steps.

 **CVAD Cap Changes (PRN):** Floor nurses **must** change caps immediately if blood is visible in a CVAD lumen (e.g., post-lab draws). This is your responsibility, *even if you do not have competency for dressing changes.*

 **Missing Competencies:** If you lack a validated facility competency for **IVAD access, line removal, or dressing changes**, it automatically becomes an immediate consult to VAN.

VAN Specialized Duties (Consult VAN for these tasks)

PLACEMENTS & ACCESS

- Places PICCs & Midlines.
- Obtains PIVs for DIVAs (Difficult Access).
- Places 2nd IV for surgeries/procedures & IV access when consulted PRN.
- Advocating for advanced access.
- Accesses/De-accesses IVADs (if RN lacks competency).
- Performs PPD skin testing.

STAT Criteria: Bypass routine scheduling and consult VAN immediately if the patient meets emergency/STAT criteria

DRESSINGS

- Performs daily checks & routine/PRN dressing changes for central lines (CVADS) and midlines.

LINE CLEARANCE & TROUBLESHOOTING

- Clears PICC lines (The only line VAN clears).
- Troubleshoots CVAD blockages/no blood return PRN prior to TPA.
- Administers TPA in lines RN may be restricted per policy (IVAD, HD).

DEVICE REMOVALS

- Central Lines & HD CVCs.
- Trimmable PICCs & Trimmable Midlines.
- IO lines (CCO can also remove).

***Note this is not all inclusive of VAN team responsibilities**